store files in storage/app/media

```
        Storage::disk('media')->put($filename, (string) $image->encode('jpg', $quality));

        // Optionally, store file path and metadata in the database if needed

        return response()->json([

            'message' => 'Image processed and uploaded successfully!',

            'filename' => $filename,

            'path' => Storage::disk('media')->url($filename)

        ]);

    }

}
```